Syllabus

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Course description

Application of machine learning tools, with an emphasis on solving practical problems. Data cleaning, feature extraction, supervised and unsupervised machine learning, reproducible workflows, and communicating results.

Class meetings

Lectures:

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Section	Day	Time	Zoom
CPSC 330 101	Tue/Thu	15:30 - 16:50	DMP 310
CPSC 330 102	Tue/Thu	11:00 - 12:20	DMP 310
CPSC 330 103	Tue/Thu	17:00 - 18:20	DMP 310

Tutorials:

Section	Day	Time	Location
CPSC 330 T1A	Fri	09:00 - 10:00	MCLD 3008
CPSC 330 T1B	Fri	11:00 - 12:00	MCML158
CPSC 330 T1C	Fri	14:00 - 15:00	FSC 1003
CPSC 330 T1D	Fri	15:00 - 16:00	FSC 1003
CPSC 330 T1E	Thu	17:00 - 18:00	FSC 1611
CPSC 330 T1F	Thu	13:00 - 14:00	CEME 1215
CPSC 330 T1G	Thu	14:00 - 15:00	FORW 317
CPSC 330 T1H	Thu	10:00 - 11:00	CEME 1215
CPSC 330 T1J	Fri	10:00 - 11:00	MCLD 3008
CPSC 330 T1K	Fri	11:00 - 12:00	MCLD 3008
CPSC 330 T1L	Thu	09:00 - 10:00	CEME 1215

Office Hours

Tutorials for this course will be conducted by TAs and follow an office hours format. Attendance at tutorials is optional. However, participating will allow you to engage in more personalized discussions with TAs, [illegible] with valuable one-on-one time and an opportunity to deepen your understanding of machine learning concepts.

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TA	Day	Time	Location
Allya Wellyanto	Monday	14:00-15:00	https://ubc.zoom.us/j/66419319451?pwd=88PknFhwGSxmWG6FlWxSukREbnQygU.1
Joseph Soo	Monday	16:00-17:00	https://ubc.zoom.us/j/67357893390?pwd=qf1nwMVNnxhSVE6s4TZJeOmh8L48BU.1

For in-person office hours, please refer to the Calendar.

Teaching Team

Instructors:

- Giulia Toti, OH: Wednesdays, 4:00 - 5:00 pm @ ICCS 231
- Varada Kolhatkar, OH: Wednesdays, 11:30 am @ ICCS 237

Course co-ordinator

- Anca Barbu (cpsc330-admin@cs.ubc.ca), please reach out to Anca for: admin questions, extensions, academic concessions etc.

TAs

- Ayanfe Adekanye
- Gaurav Bhatt
- Jun He Cui
- Felix Fu
- Neo Ghassemi
- Zoe Harris
- Zheng He
- Mishaal Kazmi
- Kanwal Mehreen

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- Himanshu Mishra
- Rubia Reis Guerra
- Kimia Rostin
- Sohbat Sandhu
- Joseph Soo
- Allya Wellyanto

Registration

Waitlists:

The general seats available in this class usually fill up very quickly. Once the general seats are taken, the only way to register for the course is to sign up for the waiting list. For questions about the waiting list policies, see here. You should sign up for the waiting list even if it is long; a lot of students tend to drop courses. Signing up for the waiting list also makes it more likely that we will open up extra sessions, expand class sizes, or offer additional courses on these topics. **The instructors have no control over the situation and cannot help you bypass the waiting list**.

Prerequisites: The official prerequisites can be found here. If you do not meet the prerequisites, see here and here. We were told that students should not visit the front desk in the CS main office about prerequisite issues, because the folks at the front desk do not have the authority to resolve prerequisite issues.

In practice, the prerequisite is familiarity with Python programming.

Auditing: If the course is full, we cannot accommodate official auditors. If there is space and you would like to audit the course, please contact the instructor. All UBC students are welcome to audit the course unofficially.

Grading scheme

The grading scheme for the course

Component	Weight	Location
Syllabus quiz	1%	PrairieLearn (through Canvas)
iClicker participation	5%	iClicker Cloud (through Canvas)
Assignments	22%	Gradescope
Midterm 1	21%	CBTF, on PrairieLearn
Midterm 2	21%	CBTF, on PrairieLearn
Final	30%	CBTF, on PrairieLearn
Tutorial participation	up to 2% bonus	in person attendance to 10 tutorials

iClicker

The iClicker participation grade will mainly consider your engagement rather than the accuracy of your responses. Nevertheless, these questions are intended to facilitate your learning, so please make an earnest effort when providing your answers. Participation in 80% of the classes is enough to receive the full participation grade - this gives you some wiggle room if you happen to miss a class or two.

Assignments

The plan is that most of the assignments will contribute equally towards the overall Assignments grade.

We will drop your lowest homework grade.

See this document for more detailed instructions on submitting homework assignments.

For the full policy on grades, see this document. We understand that grades are important for you for several reasons. But try [illegible] much on them. You will have a better learning experience and in general, you'll be happier in life if you focus more on learning the material well. For the grading scheme we wish we could use this.

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Late policy

Assignments will be due at 11:59 PM on the due date. If you cannot make this due date, you may use a “late token”. Each student will have 4 late tokens for the entire semester, which we will track on Canvas. No action is required on your part to use the tokes, just make sure that you have a sufficient number if you are planning on using them.

For example, if assignment is due on a Monday at 11:59 pm:

- Handing it anytime on Tuesday will cost you 1 late token (irrespective of whether it’s a holiday).
- Handing it anytime on Wednesday will cost you 2 late tokens (irrespective of whether it’s a holiday).

There is no penalty for using “late tokens”, but you will get a mark of 0 on an assignment if you:

- Use more than 2 late tokens on the assignment.
- Use more than 4 late tokens across all assignments.

We will post solutions 48-hours after the due date.

Lecture recordings

This is an in-person class, and we do not livestream or make recordings available by default. If you miss a class, you can catch up by reviewing the lecture notes and talking to your peers. Section 102 lectures (11 am to 12:20 am) are being recorded, but the recordings are not shared widely. Typically, the backs of students sitting in the first three to four rows may appear in the recording. If you prefer not to be recorded, please avoid sitting in those rows. When lecture recordings are available, access will be granted only to students who were absent for approved reasons (e.g., illness, jury duty).

Process to request access: If you miss a class for a legitimate reason, please contact our course coordinator at cpsc330-admin@cs.ubc.ca and provide appropriate documentation (e.g., a doctor’s note [illegible]iously ill). Your request will be reviewed, and approval may take time. Please remember that relying on recordings is not an effective way to stay on top of the course material. Regular attendance is essential for

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success.

Use of Generative AI in the course

You may use generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini) in this course, but you must use them **responsibly**. Remember, you are here to learn. These tools can speed up tasks (e.g., brainstorming, debugging, clarifying concepts), but they can also short-circuit your learning if misused (e.g., copy-pasting solutions without understanding them).

Key policies

- **Work must be your own:** All assessments must reflect your own thinking unless otherwise specified. Submitting AI-generated work without understanding it is academic dishonesty.
- If you use GenAI on an assessment:
  - **Cite it:** Name the tool (e.g., "ChatGPT").
  - **Annotate it:** Briefly explain how you used it (e.g., "I asked ChatGPT for a simple explanation of cross-validation. I compared its response with my notes, clarified one detail about data splitting, and wrote my own explanation.").
  - **If your instructor suspects overuse**, you may be asked to explain your work orally. If you cannot, penalties will apply.
  - **Do not share sensitive content:** Never paste into AI tools student information (names, IDs, personal data). In addition, do not paste course assessments (assignments, iClicker questions, exam questions) directly to generative AI tools for completion. These materials are copyrighted, and feeding them into such tools may result in redistributing them in ways we don't intend.
  - **For group work**, all team members must know about and agree to any generative AI use. The group is collectively responsible for ensuring the final work complies with this policy.

Failure to follow these rules will be treated as a violation of [UBC's academic integrity policy](#).

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Finally, always ask yourself: Is this to[illegible] learn, or harming my learning? Use it to support, not substitute, your effort.

Midterm

Check the Calendar for midterm dates.

There will be two midterms in CPSC 330 and both of them will be conducted in the CBTF via self-reservation over a three-day period. The CBTF (computer based testing facility) is designed to enhance the student's writing experience by providing them with a familiar, secure testing environment with quick access to technical support, as well as support from their instructor for common access issues.

Centre for Accessibility (CfA) Exam Accommodations

Students who are registered with the Centre for Accessibility (CfA) with exam accommodations listed below will need to write all of their assessments in the Computer-Based Testing Facility (CBTF). The CBTF will provide the following accommodations:

- Extended-time (up to 4x)
- Distraction-reduced environment
- Close proximity to washroom
- Phone permitted for medical purposes
- Medical equipment/supplies/food

If you have an accommodation that is not listed above, you will write your assessments with the CfA and will need to book a time by their deadline. Please do not book any assessments with the CfA if you are expected to write in the CBTF, as the CfA will cancel the exam booking and ask you to book it yourself with the CBTF. If you have any concerns about your accommodations being met in the CBTF, please reach out to your Accessibility Advisor.

For more information, please see the CBTF page.

Final exam

The final exam is scheduled for the [illegible]nd is likely to be comprehensive, covering the material taught over the course of the semester. **A score of 40% or more in the final exam is required to pass the course.**

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Academic concessions

UBC has a policy on academic concession for cases in which a student may be unable to complete coursework. According to this policy, grounds for academic concession can be illness, conflicting responsibilities, or compassionate grounds. Examples of compassionate grounds, from the above policy, include "a traumatic event experienced by the student, a family member, or a close friend; an act of sexual assault or other sexual misconduct experienced by the student, a family member, or a close friend; a death in the family or of a close friend." To request an academic concession, please write to the course coordinator (cpsc330-admin@cs.ubc.ca), with your section instructor copied in the email. Additional documentation might be requested. We will review your situation and determine whether to approve the concession, and if approved, the appropriate steps to follow. Please note that when possible (short term occurrences) tokens should be used as the default concession mechanism for assignments.

Code of conduct

- If you plan to engage in non-course-related activity in lecture (Facebook, YouTube, chatting with friends, etc), please sit in the last two rows of the room to avoid distracting your classmates.
- Do not distribute any course materials (slides, homework assignments, solutions, notes, etc.) without permission. **This includes copy/pasting material into AI prompts**.
- Do not photograph or record lectures (audio or video) without permission.
- If you commit to working with a partner on an assignment, do your fair share of the work.
- If you have a problem or complaint, let the instructor(s) know immediately. Maybe we can fix it!
- During the exam period, do not disclose, discuss, or share any part of the exam with any other individual, except as directly permitted or required by the course instructors. This includes discussion in person, online, or through any electronic means. Violation of this will resu[illegible] penalties, which may include failure of the exam or failure of the course.

Land acknowledgement

UBC’s Point Grey Campus is located on the traditional, ancestral, and unceded territory of the xwməθkwəy̓əm (Musqueam) people. The land it is situated on has always been a place of learning for the Musqueam people, who for millennia have passed on their culture, history, and traditions from one generation to the next on this site.

It’s important that this recognition of Musqueam territory and our relationship with the Musqueam people does not appear as just a formality. Take a moment to appreciate the meaning behind the words we use:

TRADITIONAL recognizes lands traditionally used and/or occupied by the Musqueam people or other First Nations in other parts of the country.

ANCESTRAL recognizes land that is handed down from generation to generation.

UNCEDED refers to land that was not turned over to the Crown (government) by a treaty or other agreement.

As you proceed through your journey at UBC, take some time to learn about the history of this land and to honour its original inhabitants.